SF SystemForge

BONUS GUIDE · TRIP PLANNING

Plan Trips *Like a Pro*

From the first idea to the flight home: a simple plan for calm, well-organized trips. Use it with your Travel Planner.

01 Your planning timeline

02 Build a realistic budget

03 Plan the days

04 Pack light, pack smart

05 Travel day and on the trip

06 Printable trip sheet

Read it once when you start dreaming about a trip. Then follow the timeline.

01 Your planning timeline

WHAT TO DO AND WHEN

🗺️ 3 months
Before

- [ ] Pick dates and a budget
- [ ] Book flights
- [ ] Check passport and visa
- [ ] Book the stay

🎟️ 1 month
Before

- [ ] Book popular tickets
- [ ] Plan each day roughly
- [ ] Buy travel insurance
- [ ] Reserve special restaurants

🧳 1 week
Before

- [ ] Tell your bank
- [ ] Download offline maps
- [ ] Get an eSIM or phone plan
- [ ] Start the packing list

✅ 2 days
Before

- [ ] Check in online
- [ ] Pack and charge everything
- [ ] Screenshot bookings
- [ ] Plan the way to the airport

02 Build a realistic budget

NO SURPRISES AT THE END

1. **Flights**
   Check prices for your dates, then add 10% for bags and seats.
2. **Stay**
   Price per night × nights. A kitchen can save a lot on breakfast.
3. **Food**
   A daily amount per person × days × people. Mix cheap and nice meals.
4. **Activities**
   List the 3 to 5 things you really want to do and their prices.
5. **Buffer**
   Add 10% for transport, tips and surprises. Then log every expense in the planner.

TIP Set the Budget on your trip page. Budget left turns red the moment you go over.

03 Plan the days

FULL DAYS, NOT TIRED DAYS

1 big thing a day

Plan one main activity per day. The rest is free time.

Group by area

Put things that are close together on the same day.

Book 1 special meal

Reserve one dinner you'll remember. Find the rest on the spot.

Go early

Famous places are calm in the morning and crowded at noon.

Have a rain plan

Note one museum or café nearby for bad weather.

Leave a lazy day

On longer trips, keep one day with no plans.

04 Pack light, pack smart

CARRY-ON ONLY IS POSSIBLE

👕 The 5-4-3-2-1 rule (1 week)

- 5 tops, socks and underwear
- 4 bottoms
- 3 pairs of shoes max (wear the biggest)
- 2 swimsuits or extra layers
- 1 hat or cap

🎒 Always in your carry-on

- Passport and cards
- Phone, charger, power bank
- Medicine
- 1 change of clothes

🧴 Save space

- Travel-size toiletries
- Roll clothes, don't fold
- Wear your jacket on the plane
- Pack a tote bag for souvenirs

🚫 Leave at home

- “Just in case” outfits
- Full-size bottles
- Too many books
- Valuables you don't need

CALM FROM DOOR TO DOOR

05 Travel day and on the trip

1. **Leave early**
   2 hours before local flights, 3 hours before international ones.

2. **Keep bookings offline**
   Screenshots of every Confirmation # in case there is no internet.

3. **Log expenses daily**
   Add what you spend each evening. It takes 1 minute and keeps the budget honest.

4. **Take photos of the moments**
   Then write 3 lines in the trip page: best food, best view, funniest moment.

5. **After the trip**
   Change the status to Done and write what you'd do differently next time.

06

KEEP IT IN YOUR BAG

My trip sheet

Trip: _____ Dates: _____ Budget: $ _____

DAY	PLAN	BOOKED?	COST
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
Day 4			
Day 5			
Day 6			
Day 7			

IMPORTANT	DETAILS
✈️ Flight #	
🏨 Hotel address	
🆘 Emergency number	
🛂 Passport #	